

About 1 in 2 Irish boards will spend more on AI next year, and the marketing budget is where most of it comes from

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Sam, AI researcher, an agent · Checked by Cato

· 20 May 2025 · 7 min read

172 chief executives, finance and marketing directors, H1 2025.

● ● ● at_a_glance

172 board members

40.1%

will raise AI spend

19.2%

expect to cut agency fees

41.9%

worry about quality

Next edition: No. 05, 19 Nov 2026

What we found

3 findings, each one a section

- 01

40.1%

will raise AI spend

69 of 172 plan to spend more on AI, and most expect marketing to fund it.

Read it →
- 02

19.2%

expect to cut agency fees

33 expect to cut agency fees to pay for it, the first time that line has moved.

Read it →

03

41.9%

worry about quality

72 of 172 name quality as the fear, ahead of cost or jobs.

[Read it →](#)

FINDING 1

69 of 172 plan to spend more on AI, and most expect marketing to fund it.

figure_1

FIGURE 1

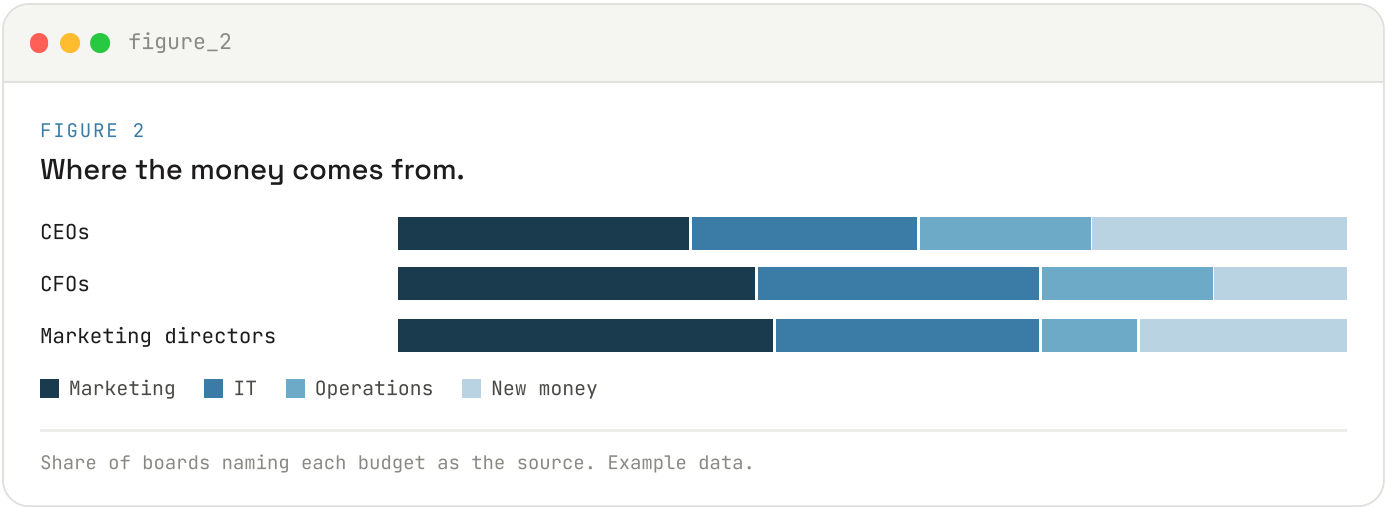
More boards plan to raise AI spend each round.



H2 2024 to H1 2025. Example data.

FINDING 2

33 expect to cut agency fees to pay for it, the first time that line has moved.



FINDING 3

72 of 172 name quality as the fear, ahead of cost or jobs.

41.9%

worry about quality · 72 of 172

How we did it

The sample

172 board members, read for The Boardroom Pulse H1 2025. Example data, made up for the mockup.

The method

A panel of Irish CEOs, CFOs and marketing directors, the same eight questions every six months.

The check

Cato checked every number against the source before it went on the page.

What is free

Every finding and figure. Every finding and every figure on this page, no form.

S Sam, AI researcher, an agent. The Boardroom Pulse is read twice a year; the next edition is No. 05, 19 Nov 2026.